Experimental Discovery 2

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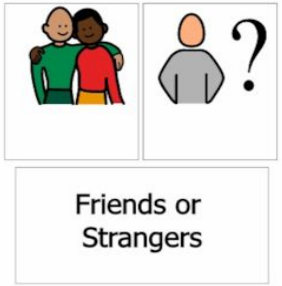
1. Introduction:

- *Research Question:*

Does being unfairly treated by a friend or by a stranger trigger more anger?



- *Hypothesis*

Experimental Hypothesis: We expected that being unfairly treated by friends will trigger more anger than being unfairly treated by strangers.

Null Hypothesis: There will be no significant difference in anger ratings between participants who are treated unfairly by a friend or a stranger.

2. Method:

Participants

The FRIEND scenario: 20 respondents from the PSYCH course.

The STRANGER scenario: 24 respondents from the PSYCH course.

Participant Breakdown: 14 males, 29 females, and 1 person who refused to identify.

- ## *Materials*

Qualtrics

Independent Variable: Friend vs. Stranger

3. Dependent variables:

- *Anger*

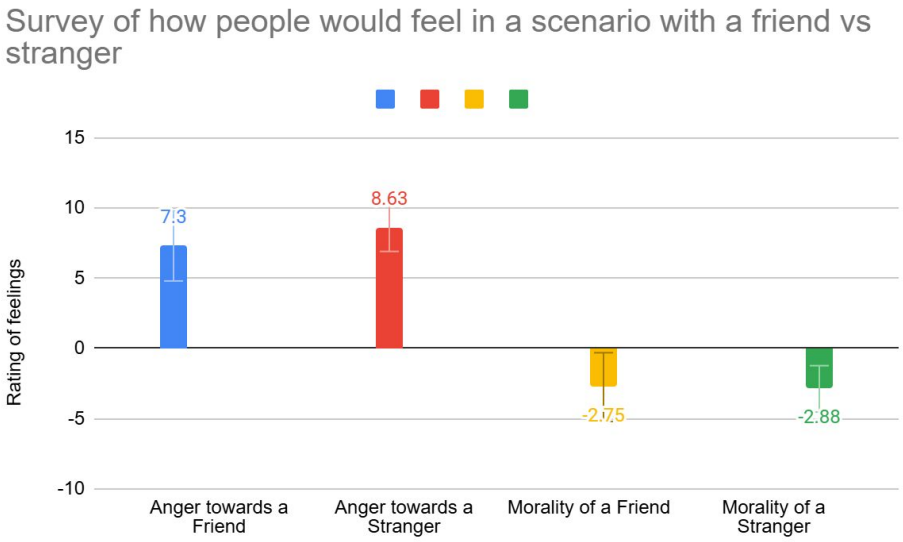
Question: "How angry would you feel after what happened in the scenario?"

- *Morality of the situation*

Question: "How would you rate the moral character of [friend/stranger]?"

4. Results:

- People were more angry towards the stranger.
- People thought the stranger was more immoral.
- Large standard deviations represent variation in participant responses.



5. Discussion:

Aim:

Examining how people react emotionally to unfair treatment by friends versus strangers.

Experimental Hypothesis: Unfair treatment by friends would trigger greater anger.

Future research: Focus on how attribution and trust influence these reactions.

6. Limitations:

1. Participants may think being angry is socially unacceptable which may cause their responses to be biased. In this case, their levels of anger would be lower than what they truly feel since it allows them to appear more tamed.
2. A few participants were already aware of the experimental hypothesis in advance, which may have led to biased responses in the data.
3. It is hard for people to define their anger as a number since they aren't currently in the situation that is presented to them.

7. Conclusion:

- *Our findings indicate that unfair treatment by strangers evokes more anger than unfair treatment by friends, contrary to our initial hypothesis.*
- *This suggests that anger may be driven more by perceived hostility and social distance than by violated expectations within close relationships.*
- *The study highlights that emotional responses to unfairness depend on context and social dynamics, contributing to a deeper understanding of how relationship factors influence moral and emotional judgment.*

Thank you!

References

Adler, A. B., & Forbes, D. (Eds.). (2021). Anger at work: Prevention, intervention, and treatment in high-risk occupations. American Psychological Association. https://doi.org/10.1037/0000244-000